

Complex Enterprise SaaS Pipeline/Deal flow review

[redacted] - Employees: ~35,000 | Revenue: \$17.6 billion
Potential Monthly Spend: Unknown; #of Freelancers to Start: Unknown; Close Date: est. 9.30.23

- **Contacts:** [redacted] (Contingent Workforce Manager, compliance analyst); [redacted] (CWM consultant)
- **Status:** Engaged; 1 discovery call held (6.29.23), 1 demo held (7.11.23)
- **Competitor:** UpWork
- **After post-demo follow up email:** They've asked a.) for clarity on sourcing fees; b.) do we integrate with Workday ATS (applicant tracking system) or SAP's Field Glass (VMS). I responded to these asks.
- **Antaeus' focus & Next step(s):**
 - **Multithread:** engage with department head(s); find allies in procurement and potentially IT; ask champions for introductions to other influential decision makers in the organization who'll potentially use the product, or at minimum have a say-so in the purchasing decision.
 - Send Us vs UpWork .pdf. *(done)*
 - Awaiting reply to my response to their integration question
 - I will then follow up with an ask to place a touch base call on the calendar
 - I will ask if their leadership would need to see a demo
 - I'll ask if they have a sense of timeline
 - We'll eventually need to know a.) their process for procuring new software, b.) who the actual project managers are, c.) who the key decision makers/budget holders are, d.) whether there is a back-up contact in the event of our champions vacationing or Outof-Office, e.) how many freelancers they plan to start on the platform with (they have hundreds, potentially thousands of contingent plant workers).
- **Why [redacted] needs Fiverr Enterprise:**
 - SAP Fieldglass, their current VMS doesn't provide the holistic view, nor the systems workflow that enables the utmost efficiency in the day-to-day management of our non-W-2 workforce.
 - [redacted] exclaimed during our product demo call that our platform looks like it has all of the tools she needs in her daily work
 - UpWork, who've they've demoed with, charges an exorbitant fee
 - They desire a built-in exclusive sourcing apparatus, compliance processing/auditing, and simplified payment process in one platform
 - Too much manual work is prohibiting the speed and advancement of goals; there's a dire need for a holistic contractor management system •
- **Risks:**
 - Competitor Influence: UpWork, being a recognized competitor, might influence [redacted]' decision, especially if they propose a similar or better offer.
 - Integration Challenges: If Fiverr Enterprise cannot satisfactorily integrate with [redacted]' existing systems, or effectively convey our product as complimentary - it could potentially hinder the deal.
 - Limited Contact and Decision-Maker Unknown: Currently, our points of contact are limited to our two champions at [redacted], [redacted] and [redacted]. Without a clear understanding of who the decision-makers and budget holders are, there is a risk of delayed or derailed deal progress due to potential unanticipated objections or approval hurdles.
- **Post Signature Game Plan: TBD, too early but will follow the standard procedures outlined above in the [redacted] rundown.**
- **Ferrari Crew Tasks - Strategy to Win:**
 - Leverage Our Strong Value Proposition: Highlight Fiverr Enterprise's comprehensive, all-in-one platform solution and how we significantly improve efficiency in managing the non-W-2 workforce in compliment to VMS.
 - **Task** - A graphic one-pager showing a direct comparison of functionality between VMS, Workday (ATS), and FiE, showing where FiE adds unique (complimentary) value. **Why this task?** A visual demonstration will help to clearly illustrate the compatibility and advantages of our platform alongside their existing VMS. This will effectively communicate how Fiverr Enterprise complements their current systems, rather than replacing them, reducing any potential friction or resistance to change.
 - Emphasize Value over Cost: Reinforce the value we deliver, not just in terms of our lower fees compared to competitors like UpWork, but value-oriented focus on the financial impact this product will have for their business in the long term.
 - **Task** - Develop a case study that demonstrates both the quantitative and qualitative successes of *a company similar to [redacted]* who utilizes FiE. The focus should be on showcasing a.) improvements in process efficiency, b.) reduction in manual labor, c.) enhanced freelancer satisfaction due to lower fees, d.) and, financial savings realized over a specific period. **Why this task?** [redacted] will see a practical application of Fiverr Enterprise's features and benefits. If we use a case study from a similar company especially - we of course make our value proposition more relatable and compelling, thus increasing the likelihood of conversion.
 - Leverage Built-in Approval Workflow: Highlight the robust and efficient approval workflow system within our platform that facilitates smooth operation at the cost center > hiring manager level. Even without a direct integration with Workday or SAP, emphasizing how our already-built features (i.e., cost center/workspaces) and approval workflow can still efficiently cater to [redacted]' needs.

[redacted] emailed us: "Do you support any integration with SAP or Workday? Curious how cost centers and [REDACTED] hiring manager approvals work in the tool."

FiE answered: "We do not directly integrate with our Workday ATS or the SAP vendor management system. However, we do have an approval workflow at the cost center > hiring manager level within the platform, absolutely."

- **Task1** - Develop external-facing product roadmap. Of course, we want to keep our communications honest and clear, but if this is indeed in our product roadmap - to work on integration possibilities, then I think that it's worth mentioning. This while of course also making sure to manage expectations about timeline and potential limitations.
- **Task2** - Create an interactive demo or a short video tutorial showing how the approval workflow operates within FiE. **Why this task?** I think that acknowledging our intentions to work on potential integrations addresses one of their major concerns head-on and shows our commitment to adapt and improve. Secondly, a visual explanation of our current workflow can help [redacted] understand how our platform can still cater to their needs even without direct integration. By doing so, we effectively bridge the gap between their existing processes and our product's functionalities. Not to mention, this asset could be used with other potential customers who have similar queries in the future.

[redacted] - Employees: - 550 | Revenue: ~\$13 million
Potential Monthly Spend: Unknown; # of Freelancers to start: Unknown; Close Date: est. 9.30.23

- **Contacts:** [redacted] (vp HR & talent acquisition), [redacted] (international recruiter), [redacted] (people & culture), [redacted] (recruiting coordinator), [redacted] (recruiter), [redacted] (hr business partner)
- **Status:** Engaged; 1 discovery call held (5.24.23), 1 demo held (7.3.23)
- **Competitors:** [Freelancer.com](#) (current favorite), UpWork
- **Antaeus' focus & Next step(s):**
 - Strike back - on 7.17.23, they said they're in favor of Freelancer.com at the moment because they have a few valuable features like, bulk approval of payments. Send Us vs. Upwork .pdf (sent 7/17/23)
 - **Multithreading:** a.) Can we build functionality to match Freelancer.com? if so, build it and have a demo. The key here is to identify who the real decision makers are, and then have all key stakeholders on the call. b.) Share with the [redacted] exploration group a case study relevant to a use case of theirs; c.) Highlight again the problems that we currently solve for them, which may spark more internal discussion in our favor. d.) Share content relative to each contact's role.
- **Why [redacted] wants to work with Fiverr Enterprise:**
 - Access to be able to exclusively source highly vetted talent

- Manual Time Tracking feature
 - We have a variety of freelancers with a very wide variety of skillsets
 - Our technical support and dedicated customer success manager
 - Our fee structure is favorable above UpWork, who they currently work with and will continue to work with due to certain features they have
- Risks**
 - Functionality wishes:**
 - ability to perform bulk approval of payments to freelancers
 - 7.17.23, [redacted] emailed us saying: "We are in discussions with Freelancer who seem to have a few valuable features that could be helpful (e.g., bulk approval of payments), however, we have not come to a final decision yet."
 - We don't have an expected timeframe for a final decision but we'll be sure to let you know. In the meantime, we'll be sure to reach out with other questions if/when they come up.
 - ability to track keystrokes/screenshots for lower-level employees
 - ability to interview directly within the platform
 - with UpWork, they currently do candidate testing and trial assignments directly within the upwork platform
- Unknowns:**
 - Procurement is unknown and not yet involved. We know that procurement should be involved in this buying process. Despite the fact that we only have the engagement of solely HR people.
 - a.) We'll eventually need to know their process for procuring new software, b.) who the actual project managers are, c.) who the key decision makers/budget holders are, d.) whether there is a back-up contact in the event of our champions vacationing or Outof-Office, e.) how many freelancers they plan to start on the platform with (they have hundreds, potentially thousands of contingent plant workers)
- Post Signature Game Plan: TBD, too early but will follow the procedures outlined for [redacted]**
- Ferrari Crew Tasks - Strategy to Win: •**
 - Offer Proof of concept
 - Task:** Meet with [redacted] to discuss their specific needs regarding bulk approval of payments and other desired features. If we can feasibly implement such a feature in a reasonable time frame, we should demonstrate a **proof of concept** to show [redacted] that we are capable of meeting their unique needs and are actively working to do so. **Why this task?** A PoC will show [redacted] that we are proactive, responsive to their needs, and capable of quick and effective product development and customization to meet their specific requirements. It reinforces our commitment to customer satisfaction and our stature as an agile software provider.
 - To the surprise of some, https://www.freelancer.com/?gclid=Cj0KCQjwk96lBhDHARIsAEKO4xasuRwf3luBz44Vtfbf0y1ex9aINTdMZfNffd6h2k8ZpWb_y4btpxkUaAnkdEALw_wcB&ft_prog=ABH&ft_prog_id=617723490147 is our competitor here. We need to know learn their fee structure and their overall product offering. We should not underestimate them. Cost doesn't matter to Enterprises - solving their problems matters. They'll pay whatever.
 - Task:** Conduct thorough research to ascertain [Freelancer.com's](https://www.freelancer.com/) fee structure. This could involve online research, user reviews, customer testimonials, indirect enquiries, disguised demo? (of course, while adhering to ethics, etc.) **Why this task?** Understanding any competitor's fee structure is crucial in knowing our position relative to their offerings. It will allow us to strategically emphasize where Fiverr Enterprise's fee structure offers more value and has far more substance in terms of what the customer needs. Furthermore, it allows us to prepare for potential price negotiations or objections raised by [redacted] during the decision-making process.
 - Highlight unique feature sets
 - Task** - Develop a comprehensive feature comparison chart showcasing FiE's features against UpWork and [Freelancer.com](https://www.freelancer.com/). This can help highlight our unique offerings and possibly reveal unconsidered benefits. **Why this task?** [redacted] is making decisions based on specific functionality. A direct comparison may bring to light additional valuable features we provide that competitors don't. If we can build for them, this will be even more effective.

Note: i've looked back at the video. [redacted] was not told that fiverr cannot provide bulk payments."

- Proactively address functionality gaps
 - Task** - Communicate our product roadmap, specifically addressing the requested functionalities (i.e., bulk payments and in-platform candidate testing). If these are planned, give a timeline that we're comfortable sharing externally. If not, explain the reasoning and potential alternative solutions. **Why this task?** - Directly addressing [redacted]'s stated concerns will increase trust in us as consultants to their problems.
- Leverage satisfied customer testimonials
 - Task** - If we have these, share testimonials and case studies from customers who've switched from Freelancer or UpWork to Fiverr Enterprise. Highlight their positive experiences, cost savings, and improved efficiencies. **Why this task?** - Demonstrating real-world success stories can instill confidence and may further help put FiE back in the lead over Freelancer.com.
- (tbd) Establish Communication with Decision Makers
 - Task:** Offer a meeting with key decision makers/budget holder. If denied, we'll need to push on our champions and doubledown on our pitch, but approach this from the perspective of the budget holders. They care about ROI. **Why this task?** Reaching the decision-makers directly can be an effective way to understand what they themselves care about; present and attach the value of our platform to their own long-term goals, especially if since all of the key information may not be getting relayed accurately or persuasively by our internal champions.

 [redacted] - Employees: 2.2k | Revenue: ~\$700 million
 Potential Monthly Spend: Unknown; # of Freelancers to Start: 1-2; Close Date: est. 9.30.23

- Contacts:** [redacted] [redacted] (Director, Global Direct and Indirect Procurement), [redacted] (VP, Procurement and Endpoints)
- Status:** in Procurement
 - 7.12.23 - Sent [redacted] the updated MSA language insertion that basically says, the sow will be based on job scope as defined in the FiE platform. Transaction fees and pricing also sent to [redacted].
 - 7.17.23 - our profile in [redacted]'s Coupa system has been approved.
- Antaeus' focus & Next step(s):**
 - Zoom call with legal to finalize MSA. To be initiated by [redacted].
 - Discuss Umbrella Vendor with [redacted]
 - [redacted] wants us to be an 'Umbrella Vendor'(for [redacted], this simplifies administrative, payroll, and tax-related processes, allowing [redacted] to focus on their core business - essentially acting as an MSP of sorts) What does this mean?
 - Discuss creating support-matrix that shows what countries we can support doing background checks in.
 - Reach out to [redacted], as we need to define the freelancer entities that will initially be put into the platform
 - Note:** [redacted] is just back from long Int'l travel so there may be a couple of days delay. I anticipate **24-48 hours** before we receive outreach to schedule zoom call with [redacted] legal.
- Post-signature Game plan:**
 - Standard procedure:
 - Welcome Communication (AE sends this communication and re-introduces CSM):** Send out a personalized welcome communication to all key stakeholders at the client's end, highlighting the next steps and expressing enthusiasm about the new partnership.
 - Kickoff Meeting Scheduling (AE, CS hosting):** Immediately work on scheduling the kickoff meeting for the project. The aim is to get everyone involved on the same page regarding expectations, timelines, and roles as quickly as possible.
 - Internal Team Briefing (pre-kickoff call w/ at least CSM, AE, management as-needed):** Organize an internal meeting with our team to discuss the signed deal in detail. Ensure everyone understands the client's needs, the project's scope, and their specific roles and responsibilities.
 - Project Manager-level procedure:
 - Onboarding Plan:** We must develop a comprehensive onboarding plan for [redacted]. Product training, setting up key performance metrics, and *most importantly*, initial success goals to ensure they start seeing value from the product as soon as possible.

- **Assign a Customer Success Manager (CSM):** Identify [redacted]'s dedicated FiE CSM to the account. This person will reach out to [redacted] post welcome email to schedule kickoff meeting. **The kickoff meeting:**
 - o Will establish a feedback loop with [redacted] from day one. This includes: a.) setting up regular check-in meetings. b.) performance reviews, and success testimony. This will not only ensure we are responsive to their needs and concerns, but also help us to anticipate any issues and mitigate churn risk.
 - o Gain understanding of [redacted]'s specific needs
 - o Assure [redacted] that they have a dedicated, primary point of contact for the life of our partnership
 - **Risks:**
 - **Primary risk:** they are starting with us in "pilot" fashion. They are starting with only *"one or two"* contractors. **Some potential problems with this are;**
 - Low Revenue Generation: The initial pilot, with few freelancers, will yield little to no revenue.
 - Misalignment of Expectations: The limited pilot may lead [redacted] to underestimate our platform's capabilities, given its potential for handling their entire Enterprise's non-w2 workforce.
 - Scalability Concerns: Rapid expansion post-pilot could strain resources, potentially affecting service quality and our reputation. This is something to keep an eye on.
 - Limited Evaluation: Starting with a few freelancers limits [redacted]'s ability to comprehensively evaluate our platform's functionality.
 - Insufficient Data for Analysis: Fewer freelancers mean less data, which may hinder the effective demonstration of our platform's analytics capabilities.
 - Risk of Perception: The small-scale pilot could lead [redacted] to perceive our platform as only suitable for smaller operations, affecting potential future expansion. Eventually leading to churn.
 - **Ferrari Crew Tasks - Strategy to Win:**
 - Communicate scalability and comprehensive platform capabilities:
 - **Task:** Create a document highlighting Fiverr Enterprise's robust scalability and the full extent of the platform's capabilities. This will address the risk of underestimation due to the limited pilot and show [redacted] the potential benefits when expanded to their broader workforce, which will likely mean more business units. **Why This Task:** We have to address the primary risk in this deal; namely, the potential underestimation of our platform's capabilities due to the limited scope of the pilot. By clearly demonstrating our ability to scale and the extensive features of our platform, we can counter any misperceptions and build confidence in our solution's ability to handle [redacted]'s larger workforce.
 - Showcase success stories of similar land-&-expand customers:
 - **Task:** Create case study(ies) of customers who started with a similar 'pilot' approach but then successfully scaled up their usage as well as their freelance workforce in the platform. This can assuage any concerns about scalability and demonstrate the platform's capacity to manage a true enterprise non-w-2 workforce. **Why This Task:** Providing concrete examples of successful expansions can substantiate our claims about scalability and Enterprise-level performance. It of course offers evidence of our past success and sets a precedent that [redacted] can potentially follow. Furthermore, this approach could inspire confidence and visualize the potential of a long-term partnership beyond the pilot phase.
 - Prioritize Desire-to-Have Features:
 - **Task:** Product team - assess the feasibility and timeline for incorporating desired features. These will certainly be desired by future potential customers. If feasible or not, we must communicate this back to [redacted], making sure to set realistic expectations. We have not done a good job of communicating our possibilities/product roadmap in our 2 Proof of Concepts. Only because we don't have the information or haven't explored these new functions into the platform. **Why This Task:** a.) [redacted] wants ability to bulk add hiring managers, without them having to individually register themselves.
(Ex: [redacted] should be able to add hiring managers in workspaces, and they can then just simply sign in with their email into [redacted]'s instance of the platform). b.) the ability to add overtime. [redacted] says that [redacted]'s overtime has to be set prior in the timesheet approval process. Rate differs when paying out. c.) [redacted]'s ideal partner solution will have the ability to manage both w-2 and non-w-2 workers.
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